

US Contractor Licensing Reference Guide

Includes quick lookup table + specialty trades + full jurisdiction detail

Contractor Licensing - Quick Lookup Table

Last reviewed: 2026-06-30 (specialty trades added)

Companion to contractor-licensing-us-states-territories.md - Specialty trades: contractor-licensing-specialty-trades.md

Legend: A = statewide GC license - B = state trade-only - C = local GC/trades - Reg = registration (not competency exam) - Muni = also check city/county (registration alone is insufficient)

All jurisdictions - state/territory level

Jurisdiction	Regime	Official verification URL	GC / contractor credential	Trades licensed at	Muni
AL	A	https://licensesearch.alabama.gov/genconbd	GC >= \$50k; HBLB residential >= \$10k	State (separate boards)	-
AK	A	https://www.commerce.alaska.gov/cbp/main/Search/Professional	Construction contractor registration	State + Anchorage	muni Yes
AZ	A	https://azroc.my.site.com/AZROC/s/contractor-search	ROC license (res + comm)	State (ROC)	-
AR	A	https://www.aclb.arkansas.gov/	Commercial >= \$50k; residential > \$2k	State	-
CA	A	https://www.cslb.ca.gov/OnlineServices/CheckLicenseII/CheckLicense.aspx	CSLB license >= \$500	State (CSLB)	-
CO	C	https://dpo.colorado.gov/Lookup	None statewide	State: elec/plumb only; GC/HVAC/roof	local Yes
CT	B	https://www.elicense.ct.gov/Lookup/LicenseLookup.aspx	HIC Reg > \$200; NHCC Reg	State Reg + state trade licenses	Yes
DE	C	https://onestop.delaware.gov/	None statewide	Local (e.g. New Castle Co.)	Yes
DC	A	https://dlcp.dc.gov/page/verify-business-license	BBL + construction endorsement	DC	-
FL	A	https://www.myfloridalicense.com/wl11.asp	DBPR contractor licenses	State	Some counties
GA	A	https://verify.sos.ga.gov/verification/	GC/residential > \$2,500	State + trade boards	-
HI	A	https://mypvl.dcca.hawaii.gov/public-license-search/	CT contractor license	State	-
ID	B	https://dopl.idaho.gov/	Registration > \$2,000	State Reg + state trade licenses	Yes
IL	C	https://online-dfpr.micropact.com/Lookup/LicenseLookup.aspx	None statewide	State: roofing + plumbing; elec/GC	local Yes
IN	C	https://mylicense.in.gov/EVERification/Search.aspx	None statewide	State: plumbing only; elec/GC/HVAC	local Yes
IA	B	https://dial.iowa.gov/licenses/building/contractors	Registration >= \$2k/yr	State Reg + PMSB trade licenses	Yes
KS	C	- (no statewide portal)	None statewide	All local	Yes
KY	B	https://hbc.ky.gov/Pages/License-Search.aspx	None statewide	State: elec/plumb/HVAC; GC	local Yes
LA	A	https://www.lslbc.louisiana.gov/contractor-search/	LSLBC license	State	-
ME	B	https://www.pfr.maine.gov/ALMSOnline/ALMSQuery/Welcomes.aspx	None statewide (residential 2027)	State: elec/plumb	Town rules
MD	B	https://www.dllr.state.md.us/license/mhic/mhic_search.shtml	MHIC home improvement	State + trade boards	Some counties
MA	B	https://www.mass.gov/info-details/massachusetts-construction-supervisor-license-csl	CSL license + HIC Reg	State	Yes
MI	B	https://www.lara.michigan.gov/colaLicVerify/	Residential builder / M&A	State + trades	-
MN	B	https://www.dli.mn.gov/business/contractors/license-and-registration-lookup	Residential builder/remodeler	State + trades	-
MS	A	https://www.msbo.com/php/verification.php	MSBOC commercial + residential	State	-
MO	C	https://pr.mo.gov/licensee-search.asp	None statewide	State: elec optional; GC/trades	local Yes
MT	B	https://erdcontractors.mt.gov/ICCROnlineSearch/registrationlookup.jsp	Contractor Reg / ICEC	State Reg + state trade licenses	Yes
NE	B	https://www.nebraska.gov/dol/contractor/search	Registration	State Reg; elec separate; Omaha/Lincoln	local Yes

NV | A | <https://app.nvcontractorsboard.com/Clients/NVSCB/Public/ContractorLicenseSearch/ContractorLicenseSearch.aspx> | NSCB license | State | -

NH | B | <https://www.oplc.nh.gov/> | None statewide | State: elec/plumb/gas; GC local | Yes

NJ | B | <https://newjersey.mylicense.com/verification/> | HIC Reg (NJHIC#) | State Reg + state trade licenses | Yes

NM | A | <https://public.rld.state.nm.us/PublicWebSearch/> | CID GB + specialty | State | -

NY | C | <https://a866-dcwpbp.nyc.gov/search> (NYC HIC) | None statewide | All local | Yes

NC | A | <https://nclicensing.org/> | GC >= \$40k | State + trade boards | -

ND | A | <https://firststop.sos.nd.gov/search/contractors> | SOS contractor license > \$4k | State | -

OH | B | https://elicense.ohio.gov/oh_verifylicense | None statewide | State: commercial trades; GC local | Yes

OK | B | https://www.ok.gov/cib/Are_They_Licensed/ | None statewide | State: elec/plumb/HVAC/roof; GC local | Yes

OR | A+B | Two lookups - see OR section | CCB Reg (all construction) | CCB + BCD trade license | -

PA | C | https://www.attorneygeneral.gov/Consumer_Home_ContractorSearch/ | HIC Reg > \$5k/yr residential | State Reg; trades/GC local | Yes

RI | B | <https://crb.ecms.ri.gov/consumer/search-registrantlicensee> | CRLB registration | State Reg + specialty licenses | Permits local

SC | A | <https://verify.llronline.com/LicLookup/Contractor/Contractor.aspx> | GC + mechanical; residential separate | State | -

SD | B | <https://dlr.sd.gov/> | None statewide | State: elec/plumb/HVAC; GC local | Yes

TN | A | <https://verify.tn.gov/> | BLC license w/ monetary limit | State | -

TX | B | <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/LicenseSearch/> | None statewide | State: HVAC/elec; TSBPE plumb; GC local Reg | Yes

UT | A | <https://secure.utah.gov/llv/search/index.html> | DOPL contractor license | State | -

VT | B | <https://sos.vermont.gov/construction-contractor-registration/> | Residential Reg >= \$10k | State Reg; trades via DPS | Permits local

VA | A | <https://www.dpor.virginia.gov/LicenseLookup> | Class A/B/C contractor | State + tradesmen | -

WA | A | <https://secure.lni.wa.gov/verify/> | Contractor registration | State Reg + state trade certs | Yes

WV | A | <https://labor.wv.gov/Pages/Contractor-Licensing.aspx> | WV contractor license | State | -

WI | B | <https://licensespace.wi.gov/> | Dwelling contractor (1-2 family) | State + trades | -

WY | C | <https://wsfm.wyo.gov/electrical-licensing> | None statewide | State: elec only; GC/plumb/HVAC local | Yes

GU | A | <https://clb.guam.gov/> | Territorial CLB license | Guam CLB | -

PR | B | <https://www.daco.pr.gov/consumidores/listado-contratistas-registrados/> | DACO contractor Reg | PR Reg; trades via Dept. of State | Yes

VI | A | https://secure.dlca.vi.gov/license/Asps/Search/License_search.aspx | DLCA business/trade license | USVI DLCA | Island-specific

CNMI | A | <https://www.cnmilicensing.gov.mp/> | BPL professional license | CNMI BPL | -

AS | A | - (no online lookup) | DOC business/contractor license | American Samoa DOC | ASG local

Oregon (OR) - dual verification required

Layer | Authority | Verification URL | Required for

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

CCB registration | Construction Contractors Board | <https://search.ccb.state.or.us/search/> | All paid construction (res + comm)

BCD trade license | Building Codes Division | <https://www.oregon.gov/bcd/licensing/pages/search.aspx> | Electrical, plumbing, boiler, elevator, manufactured dwelling, mechanical/HVAC

Active CCB alone does not authorize trade work. Verify both portals independently.

Municipal trade & GC licensing - IL, IN, NY, MO, PA

These states have no statewide GC license. Most trades are also city/county licensed. Always verify at the project municipality in addition to any state credential.

Illinois (IL)

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Trades / notes

|---|---|---|---|

State - roofing | IDFP | <https://online-dfpr.micropact.com/Lookup/LicenseLookup.aspx> | Roofing contractors (residential 1-6 units)

State - plumbing | IDPH / IDFP | Same IDFP portal | Plumbers statewide

Chicago - GC + trades | Chicago Dept. of Buildings | <https://webapps1.chicago.gov/licensedcontractors/> | GC, electrical, plumbing, masonry, elevator

DuPage Co. (unincorporated) | DuPage Building & Zoning | <https://aca-prod.accela.com/DUPAGE/GeneralProperty/PropertyLookup.aspx?TabName=Home&isLicensee=Y> | GC + sub registration

Naperville | City Building Dept | <https://www.naperville.il.us/> - contact (630) 420-6100 | Local registration

Aurora | City eTRAKiT | <https://etrakit.aurora-il.org/> | Local licenses/permits

Other IL municipalities | Local building dept | Search "[city] IL contractor license" | No statewide rollup - verify per job site

Indiana (IN)

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Trades / notes

|---|---|---|---|

State - plumbing only | IN PLA | <https://mylicense.in.gov/EVerification/Search.aspx> | Plumbers statewide

Indianapolis / Marion Co. | Indy Accela portal | <https://accela9ca.indy.gov/> | Electrical, plumbing, HVAC permits & contractors

Fort Wayne | City building dept | Contact local AHJ | Local trade + GC rules

Other IN cities | Local building dept | No statewide rollup | Electrical, HVAC, GC all local

New York (NY)

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Trades / notes

|---|---|---|---|

NYC - HIC | DCWP | <https://a866-dcwpbp.nyc.gov/search> | Home improvement > \$200 (residential)

NYC - skilled trades | NYC Dept. of Buildings | <https://www.nyc.gov/site/buildings/property-or-business-owner/find-licensed-professionals.page> | DOB-licensed trades + registrants

Nassau County | Consumer Affairs | (516) 571-2600 | County-level contractor rules

Suffolk County | Consumer Affairs | (631) 853-4600 | County-level contractor rules

Westchester County | Consumer Protection | (914) 995-2155 | County-level contractor rules

Rochester | Licensed Trades | <http://Infor.CityofRochester.gov> | Electrical, plumbing, SE/RO - call (585) 428-9339

Yonkers | Consumer Protection Bureau | (914) 377-6808 | Home improvement contractors

Other NY municipalities | Local building dept | No statewide rollup | All construction regulated locally

Missouri (MO)

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Trades / notes

|---|---|---|---|

State - electrical (optional) | MO Division of Professional Registration | <https://pr.mo.gov/licensee-search.asp> | Statewide electrical contractor license

Kansas City | CompassKC | <https://compasskc.kcmo.org/> | GC + trade Certificate of Qualification + contractor license

KC business license | Finance Dept | <https://www.kcmo.gov/city-hall/departments/finance/business-license-search> | Business license (not same as trade)

St. Louis City | License Collector + Building Div | <https://www.stlouis-mo.gov/government/departments/license/business-license-search.cfm> | GBL + Building Div trade certification (mechanical, etc.)

St. Louis County | Transportation & Public Works | Contact county - (314) 615-5184 | Mechanical/trades in unincorporated areas

Springfield / other MO cities | Local building dept | No statewide rollup | GC, plumbing, HVAC all local

Pennsylvania (PA)

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Trades / notes

|---|---|---|---|

State - HIC Reg | PA Attorney General | https://www.attorneygeneral.gov/Consumer_Home_ContractorSearch/ | Residential HIC Reg > \$5k/yr

State - asbestos/lead/crane | PA DLI | <https://www.pa.gov/agencies/dli/> | Asbestos, lead, crane operators only
 Philadelphia | L&I | <https://li.phila.gov/contractor-lookup> | Trade licenses: elec, plumb, fire, demolition, GC
 Philadelphia - trade search | L&I LMS | <https://eclipse.phila.gov/phillylmsprod/pub/lms/Default.aspx?PossePresentation=PublicTradeLicenseSearch> | Detailed trade license types
 Pittsburgh | OneStopPGH / PLI | <https://onestoppgh.pittsburghpa.gov/pghprod/webui/> | GC + trade licenses
 Other PA municipalities | Local borough/township | <https://www.pa.gov/agencies/dli/.../contractor-licensing> - contact municipality | 2,500+ municipalities may require local trade/GC licenses

Municipal follow-up - registration ? licensure

State registration (or HIC/NJHIC/DACO consumer registration) confirms administrative compliance - it is not a competency license and often does not authorize trade work. Many of these states also license trades at the state level; municipal licenses, permits, or business certificates may still be required to pull work locally.

Vetting rule: For any Muni = Yes row, always run the state registration lookup and the city/county portal for the job site.

Alaska (AK) - state registration + municipal licenses

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Notes

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

State - construction contractor Reg | AK CBPL | <https://www.commerce.alaska.gov/cbp/main/Search/Professional> | Registration with bond/insurance; check classification
 Anchorage - municipal contractor | Municipality of Anchorage BSD | <https://bsd.muni.org/contractorlicensing/search.aspx> | Separate from state Reg; trade-specific MOA license types
 Anchorage - trade / permits | Anchorage CDR lookup | <https://www.muni.org/permitcenter/views/cdr/cdrlookupmain.aspx> | Trade license, building permit, business license searches

Connecticut (CT) - HIC/NHCC registration + state trade licenses

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Notes

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

State - HIC / New Home Construction Reg | CT DCP | <https://www.elicense.ct.gov/Lookup/LicenseLookup.aspx> | Registration ? trade competency
 State - electrical, HVAC, plumbing, major work | CT DCP (same portal) | Same URL | These are licenses with exams - verify separately from HIC Reg
 Town - ROW / excavation / driveway | Local engineering dept | Contact town (e.g. Wethersfield, Newington, Guilford) | Many towns require local contractor license for work in public ROW

Iowa (IA) - DIAL registration + PMSB trade licenses

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Notes

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

State - contractor registration | DIAL | <https://dial.iowa.gov/licenses/building/contractors> | Workers' comp / UI compliance Reg >= \$2k/yr
 State - plumbing/mechanical/HVAC license | PMSB (via DIAL) | <https://dial.iowa.gov/licenses/building/plumbing-mechanical/plumbing-licensure/contractor-license> | Separate license - required for trade work
 Des Moines / Cedar Rapids / other | Local building department | Contact city where work occurs | Local permits; confirm no additional city contractor list

Idaho (ID) - contractor registration + DOPL trade licenses

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Notes

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

State - contractor registration | ID DOPL | <https://dopl.idaho.gov/> | Registration > \$2,000 - not competency examState - electrical, plumbing, HVAC | ID DOPL (trade boards) | <https://dopl.idaho.gov/e/> - <https://dopl.idaho.gov/search-category/plumbing/> | Separate trade licensesBoise | City permitting portal | <https://permits.cityofboise.org/citizenaccess/> | Search by licensed professional; local permits required**Massachusetts (MA) - HIC Reg + CSL license + local business certificate**

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Notes

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

State - Construction Supervisor License | MA BBRS / ePLACE | <https://www.mass.gov/info-details/massachusetts-construction-supervisor-license-csl> | License (exam-based) for structural workState - Home Improvement Contractor Reg | MA OCB / HIC portal | <https://www.mass.gov/orgs/office-of-consumer-affairs-and-business-regulation> | Registration for residential remodelingState - electricians, plumbers, gas fitters | MA eLIPSE / OPSI | <https://www.mass.gov/doc/verify-a-license-with-elipse> | Trade licenses at state level

Every city/town | Local city clerk + building dept | Contact municipality | Business certificate/DBA required; Boston ISD for permits

Montana (MT) - DLI registration + local + state trades

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Notes

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

State - contractor Reg / ICEC | MT DLI | <https://erdcontractors.mt.gov/ICCROnlineSearch/registrationlookup.jsp> | Registration ? competency licenseState - electrical, plumbing, boiler | MT Professional Licensing (POL) | <https://aca-prod.accela.com/POL/> | Trade licenses - verify separately

Billings / Missoula / Bozeman | Local building department | Contact city | Many cities require local contractor license and bond

Nebraska (NE) - DOL registration + major-city trade licensing

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Notes

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

State - contractor registration | NE Dept. of Labor | <https://www.nebraska.gov/dol/contractor/search> | Admin registration; exempt < \$5k/yrOmaha - building + trades | Omaha Planning / Permits | <https://aca-prod.accela.com/OMAHA/Cap/CapHome.aspx?TabName=Home&module=Licenses> | Building, electrical, mechanical, plumbing licensesOmaha - info | Omaha Permits | <https://permits.cityofomaha.org/licensing-information> | Reciprocity and exam requirementsLincoln - residential contractor | City of Lincoln PDS | <https://aca-prod.accela.com/LINCOLN/Cap/CapHome.aspx?module=Building> | Local contractor form + Accela account**New Jersey (NJ) - NJHIC Reg + state trades + municipal licenses**

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Notes

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

State - Home Improvement Contractor Reg | NJ DCA | <https://newjersey.mylicense.com/verification/> | Registration (NJHIC#) - not trade license

State - electrical, plumbing, HVAC | NJ DCA (trade boards) | Same portal / board-specific | Trade licenses separate from NJHIC

Newark | City of Newark | <https://www.newarknj.gov/345/Building-Contractor> | Local Building Contractor licenseJersey City | Jersey City DCCO | <https://www.jcnj.org/permitportal> | JC contractor license for non-state-licensed work + commercial**Rhode Island (RI) - CRLB registration + specialty licenses**

Scope | Authority | Verification URL | Notes

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

State - contractor registration | RI CRLB | <https://crb.ecms.ri.gov/consumer/search-registrantlicensee> | Registration for GC/sub work
 State - commercial roofer, well driller, etc. | RI CRLB (same portal) | Same URL | These are licenses, not just registration
 Municipal permits | Local building official | Contact city/town | Permits issued locally; verify permit holder matches CRLB record

Vermont (VT) - residential contractor registration

Scope	Authority	Verification URL	Notes
 State - residential contractor Reg | VT OPR / Secretary of State | <https://sos.vermont.gov/construction-contractor-registration/> | Reg >= \$10k residential; not competency exam
 State - electricians, plumbers | VT Dept. of Public Safety | State trade lookup | Licensed trades exempt from residential Reg
 Municipal | Local building department | Contact town | Building permits and inspections are local

Washington (WA) - L&I registration + trade certification

Scope	Authority	Verification URL	Notes
 State - contractor registration | WA L&I | <https://secure.lni.wa.gov/verify/> | Registration with bond/insurance - all contractors
 State - electrical, plumbing, elevator, etc. | WA L&I (same verify tool) | Same URL | Trade certification on same portal
 Olympia | City of Olympia | Contact city business licensing | Business license required for work in city
 Seattle | City of Seattle | Contact SDCI | No general contractor license; some trades (refrigeration, gas pipe) need city endorsement

Puerto Rico (PR) - DACO registration + trade boards

Scope	Authority	Verification URL	Notes
 State - contractor Reg | DACO | <https://www.daco.pr.gov/consumidores/listado-contratistas-registrados/> | Law 146 registration - residential construction
 State - electricians, plumbers, engineers | PR Dept. of State / PCS | <https://pr.pcshq.com/lookup/en/> | Trade licenses separate from DACO Reg
 Municipal | Local municipality | Contact municipio | Permits and additional rules may apply by municipality

Texas (TX) - TDLR/TSBPE trades + municipal GC registration

Not a registration-only state, but commonly confused - included because state trade licenses do not cover GC authorization.

Scope	Authority	Verification URL	Notes
 State - electrical, HVAC | TX TDLR | <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/LicenseSearch/> | State trade licenses
 State - plumbing | TX TSBPE | <https://www.tsbpe.texas.gov/> | Plumber license
 Austin | Austin Development Services | <https://www.austintexas.gov/development-services/contractor-registration> | Contractor registration required before permits
 Dallas | Dallas Accela | <https://aca-prod.accela.com/DALLASTX/Cap/CapHome.aspx?module=Licenses> | GC + trade registrations
 San Antonio | SA DSD / Contractor Connect | <https://aca.sanantonio.gov/CitizenAccess/> | Contractor registration required
 Houston | City building department | Contact Houston Permitting Center | Permit-based; verify local rules

Specialty trades - backflow, fire, pest, locksmith / low voltage

Full 50-state detail: [contractor-licensing-specialty-trades.md](#)

Rule: GC, plumbing, or electrical license does not prove specialty authorization. Verify the specific credential at the specialty board.

Specialty | Typical regulator | Key online lookups

| --- | --- | --- |

Backflow | Health / env / water utility; plumbing board add-on | TX TCEQ BPAT - MN DLI (BT/BF) - NY DOH county lists - WA DOH BAT - CT DPH eLicense - most others: local water purveyor

Fire - sprinkler | State Fire Marshal, contractor board | TX TDI SFMO - FL CFO/SFM - CA CSLB C-16 - SC LLR - IA DIAL - KY DHBC

Fire - alarm | SFMO, alarm board, electrical board | TX TDI SFMO - FL DBPR electrical/alarm - CA BSIS + CSLB C-7 - SC LLR burglar/fire alarm - IA DIAL alarm

Pest control | Dept. of Agriculture (DEC/DEP in NY/NJ) | NCAGR credential search - WA agr.wa.gov - CA C DPR - Kelly Solutions (`kellysolutions.com/{state}/Applicators/`)

Locksmith | BSIS, state police, locksmith board | CA BSIS - TX DPS PSB - NC Locksmith Board - MD State Police - IL IDFP (sunset 2029)

Low voltage / CCTV / access | Alarm board, limited energy, CSLB C-7 | CA CSLB C-7/C-28 + BSIS - NC SP-FA/LV - UT DOPL low voltage - FL DBPR alarm - SC LLR

Specialty - high-signal state portals

State | Backflow | Fire (sprinkler / alarm) | Pest control | Locksmith / LV / alarm

| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |

CA | Local water purveyor | CSLB C-16 / BSIS / C-7 | cdpr.ca.gov | bsis.ca.gov

FL | Local/county | myfloridacfo.com/sfm - myfloridalicense.com | fdacs.gov | myfloridalicense.com (DBPR alarm)

IA | Local | dial.iowa.gov (fire + alarm) | kellysolutions.com/ia | dial.iowa.gov

NC | Local | nclicensing.org - OSFM | ncagr.gov credential search | NC Locksmith Board - SP-FA/LV

NY | health.ny.gov cross-connection | Local (NYC DOB/FDNY) | dec.ny.gov | Local (NYC DCWP)

OK | Local | cibverify.ok.gov | Contact ODA | cibverify.ok.gov - ODOL alarm

SC | Local | llr.sc.gov (sprinkler + alarm) | regfocus.clemson.edu | llr.sc.gov burglar/fire alarm

TX | tceq.texas.gov/bpatlic | tdi.texas.gov/fire/fmli.html | texasagriculture.gov | tdlr.texas.gov - TX DPS PSB

WA | doh.wa.gov BAT | secure.lni.wa.gov/verify | agr.wa.gov license search | secure.lni.wa.gov/verify

Verification sequence for municipal states

1. State portal (registration, license, or trade as applicable)
2. Second state portal if trades are on a different board (OR: CCB + BCD; IA: DIAL + PMSB; MT: DLI + POL)
3. City/county portal for project address
4. Confirm permit can be pulled in that jurisdiction
5. Document all lookups with date and result

Specialty Trade Licensing - Backflow, Fire, Pest Control, Locksmith / Low Voltage

Companion to contractor-licensing-us-states-territories.md.

Last reviewed: 2026-06-30

Covers backflow prevention, fire protection (sprinkler / alarm / suppression), pest control (structural and commercial applicator), and **locksmith / low voltage / security alarm credentials - often licensed on separate boards** from general contractor or standard electrical/plumbing licenses.

- > Vetting rule: A valid GC, plumbing, or electrical license does not prove
- > authorization for these specialties. Verify the specific credential for the work
- > scope at the official agency for the project state (and municipality, if applicable).

Quick verification checklist

Specialty | Confirm on record | Common mistake

|---|---|---|

Backflow | Tester certification / BPAT license; ASSE/NICET cert current | Assuming plumber license covers backflow testing

Fire - sprinkler | Fire protection / sprinkler contractor license | Confusing with fire alarm or general plumbing

Fire - alarm | Fire alarm / burglar alarm / low-voltage alarm license | Confusing sprinkler license with alarm monitoring/install

Pest control | Structural pest control company + applicator/technician credentials | Confusing business Reg with certified applicator license

Locksmith | Locksmith company/employee registration (where required) | Lock work without separate alarm/low-voltage license when access control is involved

Low voltage / CCTV / access | Alarm contractor, limited energy, C-7/low-voltage classification | Standard electrical license may not cover security/CCTV (state-specific)

Backflow prevention

What it covers: Testing, repair, and installation of backflow prevention assemblies on domestic, irrigation, fire, and commercial water lines.

Regulatory pattern:

Pattern | Where | Verification approach

|---|---|---|

State environmental / health certification | TX, WA, CT, MN, NY | State tester certification list or license portal

Plumbing board add-on certification | MN, some others | Same portal as plumbing + backflow cert type (BT/BF)

Local water purveyor / county health list | Many states | Water utility approved-tester roster (no single state URL)

Fire-line backflow | TX and others | May require affiliation with approved fire-line contractor

National references: American Backflow Prevention Association (ABPA); ASSE Series 5110

tester certification (required or recognized in many states).

Backflow - state verification routes

State/Terr. | Primary authority | Verification URL / method

|---|---|---|

AL | Local water systems / ADEM | Contact local water purveyor or Alabama Department of Environmental Management

AK | DEC Drinking Water | Contact Alaska DEC drinking water program

AZ | ADEQ / local water | Contact local water utility; ADEQ cross-connection program

AR | Health dept / local | Contact local water purveyor

CA | Local water agency + health | No single statewide tester portal - verify with local water purveyor; CSLB/plumbing for install scope

CO | CDPHE | <https://cdphe.colorado.gov/water-quality>

CT | DPH Drinking Water | <https://portal.ct.gov/dph/drinking-water/dws/backflow-prevention-and-cross-connection-control> - verify cert: <https://www.elicense.ct.gov/>

DE | DNREC / local | Contact local water purveyor

DC | DC Water / DOH | Contact DC Water cross-connection control

FL | County health / water utility | Local/county approved tester lists - no single statewide lookup

GA | EPD / local | Contact local water system
 HI | DOH Safe Drinking Water | Contact Hawaii DOH
 ID | DEQ / local | Contact local water purveyor
 IL | IEPA / local | Contact local water purveyor; plumbing license for install
 IN | IDEM / local | Contact local water purveyor
 IA | DNR / local | Contact local water purveyor
 KS | KDHE / local | Contact local water purveyor
 KY | DOW / local | Contact local water purveyor
 LA | DEQ / local | Contact local water purveyor
 ME | DWP / local | Contact local water purveyor
 MD | MDE / local | Contact local water purveyor
 MA | MassDEP / local | Contact local water purveyor
 MI | EGLE / local | Contact local water purveyor
 MN | MN DLI (plumbing + backflow cert) | <https://mn.gov/elicense/> - Backflow Prevention Tester (BT) / Rebuilder (BF)
 MS | MSDH / local | Contact local water purveyor
 MO | DNR / local | Contact local water purveyor
 MT | DEQ / local | Contact local water purveyor
 NE | NDEE / local | Contact local water purveyor
 NV | NDEP / local | Contact local water purveyor
 NH | DES / local | Contact local water purveyor
 NJ | DEP / local | Contact local water purveyor
 NM | EMNRD / local | Contact local water purveyor
 NY | DOH | https://www.health.ny.gov/environmental/water/drinking/cross/backflow_testers/ (county lists)
 NC | DEQ / local | Contact local water purveyor
 ND | NDDoH / local | Contact local water purveyor
 OH | EPA / local | Contact local water purveyor
 OK | DEQ / local | Contact local water purveyor
 OR | OHA / local | Contact local water purveyor
 PA | DEP / local | Contact local water purveyor
 RI | RIDOH / local | Contact local water purveyor
 SC | DHEC / local | Contact local water purveyor
 SD | DENR / local | Contact local water purveyor
 TN | TDEC / local | Contact local water purveyor
 TX | TCEQ | <https://www.tceq.texas.gov/licensing/licenses/bpatlic> - BPAT license required to test/repair
 UT | DEQ / local | Contact local water purveyor
 VT | DEC / local | Contact local water purveyor
 VA | DEQ / local | Contact local water purveyor
 WA | DOH | <https://doh.wa.gov/...> - BAT certification verification via Washington Certification Services
 WV | DEP / local | Contact local water purveyor
 WI | DNR / local | Contact local water purveyor
 WY | DEQ / local | Contact local water purveyor
 GU | GWA / public health | Contact Guam Waterworks Authority
 PR | PRASA / health | Contact local water utility
 VI | DPW / health | Contact local water authority

Fire protection (sprinkler, alarm, suppression)

What it covers:

- **Sprinkler / water-based:** Installation, inspection, and service of automatic sprinkler systems
- **Special hazards / suppression:** Kitchen hood, clean agent, dry chemical systems
- **Fire alarm / detection:** Install, monitor, service fire alarm and often burglar alarm systems
- **Fire equipment:** Portable extinguishers, hood systems (sometimes separate dealer license)

Regulatory pattern:

Pattern | Examples | Notes

|---|---|---|

State Fire Marshal (SFM0) | TX, FL, LA, NV | Company + individual licenses; often separate sprinkler vs alarm
 Contractor licensing board | SC LLR, NC, TN, CA CSLB | Fire sprinkler as classification; alarm may be separate board
 Construction / CIB board | OK CIB, IA DIAL | Fire extinguishing + alarm programs
 Electrical / alarm board | FL DBPR Electrical, GA | Alarm work under electrical contractor licensing
 Municipal | NYC, Chicago, Philadelphia | Fire alarm often on L&I trade license (see municipal tables)

Fire - state verification routes

State/Terr. | Sprinkler / suppression | Fire alarm / detection | Verification URL

|---|---|---|

AL | SFMO / building | AESBL (Electronic Security Board) | AL SFMO; <https://www.aesbl.alabama.gov/>
 AK | SFMO / local | Often electrical + local | Alaska DEC Fire & Life Safety
 AZ | ROC specialty / SFMO | ROC / electrical | <https://azroc.my.site.com/AZRoc/s/contractor-search>
 AR | SFMO / local | State Police alarm (Act 393) | Arkansas State Police alarm licensing
 CA | CSLB C-16 Fire Protection | BSIS alarm / CSLB C-7 low voltage | CSLB: <https://www.cslb.ca.gov/OnlineServices/CheckLicenseII/CheckLicense.aspx> - BSIS: https://www.bsis.ca.gov/online_services/verify_license.shtml
 CO | Local / DORA | Local / low-voltage rules | <https://dpo.colorado.gov/Lookup>
 CT | SFMO / DCP | DCP / electrical | <https://www.elicense.ct.gov/>
 DE | SFMO | Local / electrical | Delaware State Fire Marshal
 DC | DC FEMS | DLCP / electrical | <https://fems.dc.gov/>
 FL | CFO State Fire Marshal | DBPR Electrical Contractors (alarm) | SFM: <https://www.myfloridacfo.com/division/sfm/bfp/regulatory-licensing> - DBPR: <https://www.myfloridalicense.com/wl11.asp>
 GA | SFMO / GC board | Low-voltage electrical (GSCB) | <https://verify.sos.ga.gov/verification/>
 HI | SFMO | CSLB-equivalent / electrical | Hawaii SFMO
 ID | SFMO / DOPL | DOPL / electrical | <https://dopl.idaho.gov/>
 IL | SFMO / local | Chicago DOB / IDFPR | Chicago: <https://webapps1.chicago.gov/licensedcontractors/>
 IN | SFMO / local | Local / electrical | <https://mylicense.in.gov/EVerification/>
 IA | DIAL Fire Protection | DIAL Alarm (separate programs) | <https://dial.iowa.gov/licenses/alarms-fire/fire-protection-system-licensing>
 KS | SFMO / local | Local | Contact local AHJ
 KY | DHBC sprinkler | DHBC / electrical | <https://hbc.ky.gov/Pages/License-Search.aspx>
 LA | State Fire Marshal + LSLBC | LSLBC / SFMO | <https://www.lslbc.louisiana.gov/contractor-search/>
 ME | SFMO | Electrical board | <https://www.pfr.maine.gov/ALMSOnline/>
 MD | SFMO / MHCC | MHCC / electrical | <https://www.dllr.state.md.us/license/mhic/>
 MA | SFMO / OPSI | Electrical / alarm where required | MA SFMO; eLIPSE trade lookup
 MI | LARA / SFMO | LARA / electrical | <https://www.lara.michigan.gov/colaLicVerify/>
 MN | SFMO / DLI | DLI / electrical | <https://www.dli.mn.gov/business/contractors/license-and-registration-lookup>
 MS | SFMO / MSBOC | MSBOC / electrical | <https://www.msbo.us/php/verification.php>
 MO | SFMO / local (KC, STL) | Local / KC CompassKC | <https://compasskc.kcmo.org/> (KC backflow + fire trades)
 MT | SFMO / POL | POL / electrical | <https://aca-prod.accela.com/POL/>
 NE | SFMO / Omaha local | Omaha license search | <https://aca-prod.accela.com/OMAHA/>
 NV | NSCB + SFMO | NSCB specialty / SFMO | <https://app.nvcontractorsboard.com/.../ContractorLicenseSearch.aspx>
 NH | SFMO | OPLC electrical | <https://www.oplc.nh.gov/>

NJ | DCA / SFMO | NJ Division of Fire Safety / alarm | <https://newjersey.mylicense.com/verification/>
 NM | CID / SFMO | CID / electrical | <https://public.rld.state.nm.us/PublicWebSearch/>
 NY | Local FDNY / county | Local - NYC DOB / FDNY | NYC: <https://www.nyc.gov/site/buildings/index.page>
 NC | NCLBGC / SFMO | NC SP-FA/LV special restricted electrical | <https://nclicensing.org/> - NC OSFM
 ND | SFMO | Electrical board | <https://firststop.sos.nd.gov/>
 OH | SFMO / OCILB | OCILB commercial electrical | https://elicense.ohio.gov/oh_verifylicense
 OK | CIB (some fire trades) | CIB + OK Alarm/Fire programs | <http://cibverify.ok.gov/>
 OR | BCD / CCB + SFMO | BCD / CCB | CCB + BCD (see main OR section)
 PA | L&I / local | Philadelphia L&I fire alarm trade | <https://li.phila.gov/contractor-lookup>
 RI | CRLB / SFMO | CRLB / electrical | <https://crb.ecms.ri.gov/>
 SC | LLR Fire Sprinkler | LLR Burglar & Fire Alarm | <https://www.llr.sc.gov/clb/>
 SD | SFMO | DLR electrical | <https://dlr.sd.gov/>
 TN | BLC / SFMO | BLC / alarm board | <https://verify.tn.gov/>
 TX | TDI State Fire Marshal | TDI SFMO (sprinkler + alarm) | <https://www.tdi.texas.gov/fire/fmli.html> - company/individual search
 UT | DOPL / SFMO | DOPL low voltage | <https://secure.utah.gov/llv/search/>
 VT | SFMO | DPS / electrical | <https://sos.vermont.gov/>
 VA | DPOR / SFMO | DPOR trades / low voltage | <https://www.dpor.virginia.gov/LicenseLookup>
 WA | L&I / SFMO | L&I electrical / specialty | <https://secure.lni.wa.gov/verify/>
 WV | SFMO / Labor | WV Division of Labor | <https://labor.wv.gov/>
 WI | DSPS / SFMO | DSPS electrical | <https://licensespace.wi.gov/>
 WY | SFMO | Local / electrical | <https://wsfm.wyo.gov/>

Pest control (structural pest & commercial applicator)

What it covers: Termite/WDO treatment, rodent control, general structural pest control, and application of pesticides in and around buildings (commercial applicator categories).

Regulatory pattern: Nearly always the state Department of Agriculture (or Environmental Conservation / DEP in NY, NJ). Separate from contractor GC licensing.

Categories to verify:

Credential	Who holds it
 Company license | Pest control business operating in state
 Certified applicator / operator | Supervisory credential
 Registered technician | Technician working under supervisor
 Commercial applicator category | Specific pest types (structural, WDO, fumigation, etc.)

National reference: Association of American Pesticide Control Officials (AAPCO) maintains state agency contacts - <https://aapco.org/>

Many states use Kelly Solutions for online applicator lookup:
 `https://www.kellysolutions.com/{state}/Applicators/` (not all states).

Pest control - state verification routes

State/Terr.	Authority	Verification URL

AL | AL Dept of Agriculture | <https://www.kellysolutions.com/al/Applicators/>
 AK | AK Dept of Environmental Conservation | Contact ADEC pesticides program
 AZ | AZ Dept of Agriculture | <https://www.kellysolutions.com/az/Applicators/>
 AR | AR State Plant Board | Contact (501) 225-1598 - limited online
 CA | CA Dept of Pesticide Regulation (CDPR) | <https://www.cdpr.ca.gov/docs/license/currlic.htm>
 CO | CO Dept of Agriculture | Contact CO Dept of Agriculture pesticides
 CT | CT Dept of Energy & Environmental Protection | Contact DEEP
 DE | DE Dept of Agriculture | <https://www.kellysolutions.com/de/Applicators/>
 DC | DC D0EE | Contact D0EE pesticides
 FL | FL Dept of Agriculture (FDACS) | <https://www.fdacs.gov/Divisions-Offices/Agricultural-Environmental-Services>
 GA | GA Dept of Agriculture | <https://agr.georgia.gov/structural-pest>
 HI | HI Dept of Agriculture | Contact HDOA pesticides branch
 ID | ID Dept of Agriculture | <https://agri.idaho.gov/main/agri-services/pesticides/licensing/>
 IL | IL Dept of Agriculture | <https://agr.illinois.gov/pests/pesticide/applicators.html>
 IN | IN State Chemist / OISC | <https://www.kellysolutions.com/in/applicators/>
 IA | IA Dept of Agriculture | <https://www.kellysolutions.com/ia/Applicators/>
 KS | KS Dept of Agriculture | Contact KDA pesticides
 KY | KY Dept of Agriculture | <https://www.kyagr.com/consumer/pesticide-applicators.html>
 LA | LA Dept of Agriculture | Contact LDAF pesticides
 ME | ME Board of Pesticides Control | <https://www.maine.gov/dacf/php/pesticides/>
 MD | MD Dept of Agriculture | <https://www.kellysolutions.com/MD/Applicators/>
 MA | MA Dept of Agricultural Resources | Contact MDAR pesticides
 MI | MI Dept of Agriculture (MDARD) | <https://www.michigan.gov/mdard>
 MN | MN Dept of Agriculture | <https://www.mda.state.mn.us/pesticides-fertilizers>
 MS | MS Bureau of Plant Industry | Contact MDAC pesticide program
 MO | MO Dept of Agriculture | <https://mda.mo.gov/plants/pesticides/licensing>
 MT | MT Dept of Agriculture | <https://agr.mt.gov/Licensing>
 NE | NE Dept of Agriculture | Contact NDA pesticides
 NV | NV Dept of Agriculture | <https://agri.nv.gov/Pesticide/>
 NH | NH Dept of Agriculture | https://www.nh.gov/agric/divisions/pesticide_control/
 NJ | NJ Dept of Environmental Protection | <https://www.nj.gov/dep/enforcement/pcp/>
 NM | NM Dept of Agriculture | Contact NMDA pesticides
 NY | NY Dept of Environmental Conservation | <https://www.dec.ny.gov/permits/209.html>
 NC | NCDA&CS Structural Pest Control | <https://www.ncagr.gov/divisions/structural-pest-control-and-pesticides/credential-search>
 ND | ND Dept of Agriculture | Contact NDDA pesticides
 OH | OH Dept of Agriculture | <https://agri.ohio.gov/wps/portal/gov/oda/divisions/plant-health/pesticide-program>
 OK | OK Dept of Agriculture | Contact ODA Consumer Protection Services
 OR | OR Dept of Agriculture | <https://oda.state.or.us/dbs/licenses/search.lasso?&division=pest>
 PA | PA Dept of Agriculture | <https://www.paplants.state.pa.us/PesticideApplicator/ApplicatorExternalSearch.aspx>
 RI | RI DEM | Contact RIDEM pesticides
 SC | SC Dept of Pesticide Regulation (Clemson) | <http://regfocus.clemson.edu/dpr/>
 SD | SD Dept of Agriculture | Contact SDDA
 TN | TN Dept of Agriculture | <https://www.tn.gov/agriculture/businesses/pesticides.html>
 TX | TX Dept of Agriculture (TDA) | <https://www.texasagriculture.gov/Regulatory-Programs/Pesticides>
 UT | UT Dept of Agriculture | <https://webapp.ag.utah.gov/LicenseLookup/licenseSearch.jsp>
 VT | VT Agency of Agriculture | <https://www.kellysolutions.com/VT/Applicators/>
 VA | VA Dept of Agriculture (VDACS) | <https://www.vdacs.virginia.gov/pesticides.shtml>
 WA | WSDA | <https://www.agr.wa.gov/Services/Licenses-Permits-and-Certificates/Pesticide-License-and-Recertification/Pesticide-and-SPI-Licensing/License-Search>
 WV | WV Dept of Agriculture | <https://www.kellysolutions.com/wv/Applicators/>
 WI | WI Dept of Agriculture (DATCP) | <https://www.kellysolutions.com/WI/Applicators/>
 WY | WY Dept of Agriculture | Contact WDA pesticides

GU | Guam Dept of Agriculture | Contact Guam DA
 PR | PR Dept of Agriculture | Contact PR DA pesticides
 VI | VI Dept of Agriculture | Contact VI DA

Locksmith, low voltage, security alarm & CCTV

What it covers:

- **Locksmith:** Locks, safes, rekeying, non-electronic access hardware
- **Low voltage / limited energy:** CCTV, access control, structured cabling (often 50-91V)
- **Security / fire alarm:** Burglar alarm, fire alarm monitoring and installation
- **Electronic access control:** Often spans locksmith + alarm + low-voltage licenses

Regulatory pattern:

Pattern | States / examples

| --- | --- |

Dedicated locksmith license | CA, TX, NC, VA, MD, NV, NJ, OK, OR, AL, LA, IL (sunset 2029)

Alarm / security contractor license | FL (DBPR electrical/alarm), SC (LLR), TX (DPS/private security + alarm), OK (CIB)

Low-voltage electrical classification | CA C-7, NC SP-FA/LV, UT low voltage, TN alarm licenses

Electronic Security Board | AL (AESBL), AR (State Police alarm)

Exempt under electrical (limited) | CO, GA, AR (partial), HI (partial) - verify scope

Municipal only | Many cities when no state license

Important: Installing electronic access control, CCTV, or fire alarm usually requires credentials beyond a locksmith license. Verify alarm/low-voltage/fire alarm classification separately.

Locksmith / low voltage / alarm - state verification routes

State/Terr. | Locksmith | Alarm / security / CCTV / access | Verification URL

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

AL | Regulated | AESBL (Electronic Security Board) | <https://www.aesbl.alabama.gov/>

AK | Local / none | Electrical registration | <https://www.commerce.alaska.gov/cbp/main/Search/Professional>

AZ | Business / ROC | ROC specialty / electrical | <https://azroc.my.site.com/AZRoc/s/contractor-search>

AR | None statewide | AR State Police alarm license | Arkansas State Police alarm licensing

CA | BSIS Locksmith Co. + Employee | BSIS Alarm + CSLB C-7 low voltage | https://www.bsis.ca.gov/online_services/verify_license.shtml - CSLB for C-7/C-28

CO | None statewide | DORA electrical / 50V security exemption | <https://dpo.colorado.gov/Lookup>

CT | None statewide | DCP / electrical | <https://www.elicense.ct.gov/>

DE | None statewide | Local / electrical | <https://onestop.delaware.gov/>

DC | DLCP locksmith | DLCP security/alarm endorsement | <https://dlcp.dc.gov/page/verify-business-license>

FL | None statewide | DBPR Electrical Contractors (alarm) | <https://www.myfloridalicense.com/wl11.asp>

GA | None statewide | GSCB low-voltage / electrical | <https://verify.sos.ga.gov/verification/>

HI | None statewide | Electrical / CSL | <https://mypvl.dcca.hawaii.gov/public-license-search/>

ID | Regulated | DOPL electrical | <https://dopl.idaho.gov/>

IL | IDFPF Locksmith (program sunset 2029) | Chicago DOB / IDFPF | <https://online-dfpr.micropact.com/Lookup/LicenseLookup.aspx>

IN | Regulated | Local / electrical | <https://mylicense.in.gov/EVERification/>

IA | None statewide | DIAL alarm / electrical | <https://dial.iowa.gov/>

KS | None statewide | Local | Contact local AHJ

KY | None statewide | HBC electrical / local | <https://hbc.ky.gov/>
 LA | State locksmith board | SFMO / electrical | LA Office of State Fire Marshal; state locksmith program
 MD | MD State Police locksmith | MHCC / electrical | MD State Police locksmith licensing
 MA | None statewide | Electrical / opsi | eLIPSE / OPSI
 MI | None statewide | LARA / local | <https://www.lara.michigan.gov/colaLicVerify/>
 MN | None statewide | DLI electrical / alarm where required | <https://www.dli.mn.gov/>
 MS | None statewide | MSBOC / electrical | <https://www.msbooc.us/>
 MO | None statewide | Local (KC, STL) | <https://compasskc.kcmo.org/>
 MT | None statewide | POL electrical | <https://aca-prod.accela.com/POL/>
 NE | None statewide | Omaha local trades | <https://aca-prod.accela.com/OMAHA/>
 NV | County sheriff (varies) | NSCB / local | NSCB + local sheriff locksmith card (Clark County etc.)
 NH | None statewide | OPLC electrical | <https://www.oplc.nh.gov/>
 NJ | NJ Fire Alarm / Locksmith (DCF) | NJ Division of Consumer Affairs | <https://newjersey.mylicense.com/verification/>
 NM | None statewide | CID / electrical | <https://public.rld.state.nm.us/PublicWebSearch/>
 NY | NYC DCWP (local) | Local - NYC DOB / Nassau / Suffolk | NYC: <https://a866-dcwppb.nyc.gov/search>
 NC | NC Locksmith Board | NC SP-FA/LV + alarm board | NC Locksmith Board; NC Electrical Board SP-FA/LV
 ND | None statewide | Electrical | <https://firststop.sos.nd.gov/>
 OH | None statewide | OCILB / local | https://elicense.ohio.gov/oh_verifylicense
 OK | ODOL Alarm & Locksmith + CIB | CIB / ODOL | <http://cibverify.ok.gov/> - OK ODOL alarm/fire
 OR | BSIS-equivalent (CCB + DPS) | CCB + low voltage | CCB search + OR Building Codes Division
 PA | None statewide | Philadelphia L&I (fire alarm, low voltage trades) | <https://eclipse.phila.gov/phillylmsprod/pub/lms/>
 RI | None statewide | CRLB / electrical | <https://crb.ecms.ri.gov/>
 SC | None statewide | LLR Burglar & Fire Alarm | <https://www.llr.sc.gov/clb/>
 SD | None statewide | DLR electrical | <https://dlr.sd.gov/>
 TN | None statewide | Alarm contractor licenses (BLC) | <https://verify.tn.gov/>
 TX | TX Dept of Public Safety (PSB) | TX DPS Private Security + alarm | <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/> (trades) - TX DPS PSB for locksmiths/security
 UT | Regulated | DOPL low voltage (?95V) | <https://secure.utah.gov/llv/search/>
 VT | None statewide | DPS / electrical | <https://sos.vermont.gov/>
 VA | VA DCJS / DPOR | DPOR trades / low voltage | <https://www.dpor.virginia.gov/LicenseLookup> - VA DCJS for private security
 WA | None statewide | L&I electrical / limited energy | <https://secure.lni.wa.gov/verify/>
 WV | None statewide | Labor / electrical | <https://labor.wv.gov/>
 WI | None statewide | DSPS electrical | <https://licensespace.wi.gov/>
 WY | None statewide | Local / electrical | <https://wsfm.wyo.gov/>

Texas note: Locksmiths fall under **TX Dept of Public Safety - Private Security Board** (not TDLR). Alarm installers may also need SFMO (TDI) fire alarm licensing.

California note: Locksmith = BSIS. CCTV/access/low voltage = CSLB C-7.
 Fire alarm monitoring/install may require BSIS alarm credentials. C-28 covers lock/security equipment contractor scope on CSLB.

Cross-specialty vetting scenarios (Vixxo SP context)

Work scope | Minimum credentials to verify

|---|---|

Backflow test at commercial site | State/local BPAT or certified tester + (if repair) plumbing/backflow cert

Fire sprinkler inspection/repair | State fire sprinkler contractor license + any CCB/GC/local GC

Fire alarm panel service | Fire alarm contractor license (not sprinkler) + low-voltage where required

Rodent / termite treatment | Structural pest control company license + certified applicator

Door hardware rekey only | Locksmith (if state requires)
 Access control / CCTV install | Alarm/low-voltage/electrical - not locksmith alone
 Integrated fire + security | Multiple licenses across fire alarm, low voltage, and possibly sprinkler boards

External reference sources

Resource | URL | Use for

| --- | --- | --- |

AAPCO (pesticide agencies) | <https://aapco.org/> | State pesticide agency contacts

Kelly Solutions (pesticide lookups) | <https://www.kellysolutions.com/> | Many state applicator searches

ABPA (backflow) | <https://www.abpa.org/> | Tester certification standards

NSCA state licensing guide | <https://www.nsca.org/resources/guide-to-state-licensing/> | Low voltage / alarm by state

TX TCEQ BPAT | <https://www.tceq.texas.gov/licensing/licenses/bpatlic> | Texas backflow tester licensing

TX TDI SFMO fire industry | <https://www.tdi.texas.gov/fire/fmli.html> | Texas fire sprinkler/alarm

CA BSIS license verify | https://www.bsis.ca.gov/online_services/verify_license.shtml | CA locksmith/alarm/security

NC structural pest search | <https://www.ncagr.gov/divisions/structural-pest-control-and-pesticides/credential-search> | NC pest credentials

Integration with main vetting workflow

When a service provider performs specialty work, add these checks to the Manual Review Checklist:

- ☐ Confirm specialty credential type matches scope (backflow vs fire sprinkler vs alarm vs pest vs locksmith/LV).
- ☐ Verify at the ****specialty board portal****, not only GC/plumbing/electrical.
- ☐ For fire alarm work, confirm ****alarm**** license - not sprinkler-only.
- ☐ For pest work, confirm ****company license**** and ****applicator/technician**** credentials.
- ☐ For access control/CCTV, confirm ****low-voltage/alarm**** license - not locksmith-only.
- ☐ Check municipal trade license if state registration is administrative only.

US Contractor Licensing Reference Guide

Reference for service provider vetting - license verification portals, required credentials, and jurisdiction-specific notes for all 50 states, Washington D.C., and five U.S. territories.

Last reviewed: 2026-06-30

Primary upstream sources: Official state/territory agency websites; NASCLA (Contractor State Licensing Information Directory); cross-checked against public licensing directories.

- > Always verify at the official source. URLs, thresholds, fees, and board
- > jurisdictions change. This guide is a starting point, not legal advice.

Quick lookup: [contractor-licensing-quick-lookup-table.md](#)

Specialty trades: [contractor-licensing-specialty-trades.md](#) - backflow, fire, pest, locksmith/low voltage

PDF export: [contractor-licensing-us-states-territories.pdf](#)

How to use this guide

1. Identify the state or territory where the work will be performed (not where the SP is headquartered).
2. Find the jurisdiction in the master table.
3. Open the official verification URL and search by license number and legal business name.
4. Confirm status = Active/Current, classification matches scope, and name matches contract/invoice.
5. If the regime is Trade-only or Local-only, run additional lookups for trades and the city/county building department.
6. Document findings with lookup date and screenshot or saved record URL.

Minimum verification fields

Field | Why it matters

|---|---|

License/registration number | Primary key for board lookup

Legal business name | Must match contract and payment recipient

License status | Active vs. expired, suspended, revoked

Classification / endorsement | Plumbing license ? general building

Expiration date | Lapsed licenses block permits and recourse

Bond / insurance / workers' comp | Shown on many boards; confirm when available

Disciplinary / complaint history | Patterns matter more than isolated old entries

Qualifying party / RMO / qualifier | Many boards license the business through a person

Licensing regime types

Contractor regulation in the U.S. is not federal. Three broad patterns apply:

Regime | Description | Count (states + DC) | Examples

|---|---|---|---|

A - Statewide GC license | State board issues general-contractor licenses (often with classifications) plus separate trade boards | ~24 | CA, AZ, NV, FL, LA, NC, TN, UT, VA

B - Trade-only (state) | State licenses specific trades (electrical, plumbing, HVAC, roofing); GC handled locally | ~19 | TX, OH, KY, MN, MD, MA, NJ, CT

C - No statewide GC license | No state-level general contractor competency license; city/county rules apply | 7 states | CO, IL, IN, MO, NY, PA, WY

Registration vs. license: Some states require *registration* (administrative filing, insurance, workers' comp) without a competency exam - e.g., OR CCB, IA contractor registration, NE contractor registration, PA/NJ/CT HIC registration.

Registration still must be verified and is legally required, but ****does not replace**** trade competency licenses or municipal contractor credentials.

When a state row shows Reg or registration, assume municipal follow-up is likely. See Municipal follow-up - registration ? licensure.

Home improvement (HIC) vs. general contractor: Many states split residential remodeling/home improvement from commercial GC licensing. Check both when work is residential or mixed-use.

Trade licenses (nearly always separate)

Trades are licensed at the state level in many jurisdictions, but in IL, IN, NY, MO, PA (and other Regime C states) electrical, plumbing, HVAC, and GC credentials are often municipal - verify at the city/county where work occurs. See Municipal licensing - no statewide GC and Municipal follow-up - registration ? licensure.

Trade | Typical licensing agency pattern

| --- | --- |

Electrical | State board, fire marshal, or local building dept. (IL, IN, NY, MO, PA)

Plumbing | State board (IN: statewide; IL: state; NY/MO/PA: often local)

HVAC / mechanical / refrigeration | State mechanical board or local (especially IL, IN, MO, PA)

Roofing | State board (IL: IDFPR), AG registration, or local

Asbestos / lead / abatement | EPA + state environmental or labor agency

Fire protection (sprinkler / alarm / suppression) | State fire marshal, contractor board, or local - sprinkler and alarm are often separate licenses

Backflow prevention (testing / repair) | Health dept, env quality, water utility, or plumbing board add-on - often local water purveyor lists

Pest control (structural / commercial applicator) | State Dept. of Agriculture (DEC/DEP in NY/NJ) - company + applicator credentials

Locksmith / low voltage / security alarm | BSIS, alarm board, limited-energy electrical, or local - access control/CCTV usually not covered by locksmith alone

For commercial facilities work (Vixxo SP context), verify both the GC credential (state or local) and every trade license for self-performed work.

Specialty trades detail: See contractor-licensing-specialty-trades.md for per-state verification URLs for backflow, fire protection, pest control, and locksmith/low voltage/alarm credentials.

Oregon - CCB registration AND BCD trade licenses

Oregon requires two independent credentials for most construction work:

Layer | Authority | Verification URL

| --- | --- | --- |

CCB registration | Construction Contractors Board | <https://search.ccb.state.or.us/search/>

BCD trade license | Building Codes Division (DCBS) | <https://www.oregon.gov/bcd/licensing/pages/search.aspx>

- ****CCB**** is required for virtually all paid construction (residential and commercial) - registration with bond, insurance, and endorsements.

- ****BCD**** separately licenses electrical, plumbing, boiler, elevator, manufactured dwelling, and mechanical/HVAC trades.

- An active CCB record does **not** prove trade authorization. An active BCD trade license does not substitute for CCB registration. Verify both portals when trade work is involved.
- Official guidance: <https://www.oregon.gov/bcd/lbddd/pages/licensed-work.aspx>

Master table

Columns: Regime - Primary authority - Verification URL -

What's required - **Key notes**

Alabama (AL)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide (split boards)
Primary authority | AL Licensing Board for General Contractors (ALGC)
Verification | GC roster: <https://licensesearch.alabama.gov/genconbd>
Required | Commercial/multifamily GC work >= \$50,000 - ALGC license. Single-family residential >= \$10,000 - AL Home Builders Licensure Board (HBLB). Separate boards for electrical, plumbing, HVAC, gas.
Secondary lookup | HBLB: <https://alhobv7prod.glsuite.us/GLSuiteWeb/Clients/ALHOB/Public/LicenseeSearch.aspx>
Notes | Swimming pool contractors >= \$5,000 use ALGC. Local permits still required.

Alaska (AK)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide registration + classifications
Primary authority | AK Dept. of Commerce, Community & Economic Development - CBPL
Verification | <https://www.commerce.alaska.gov/cbp/main/Search/Professional>
Required | Construction contractor registration (residential, commercial, specialty, mechanical) with bond/insurance, plus business license.
Notes | Registration is not optional for construction contracting. Check classification on record.

Arizona (AZ)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide
Primary authority | AZ Registrar of Contractors (ROC)
Verification | <https://azroc.my.site.com/AZRoc/s/contractor-search>
Required | ROC license for residential and commercial contracting; dual classification system (commercial/residential × general/specialty).
Notes | Record shows bond, complaint history, and license classification - read full record.

Arkansas (AR)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide

Primary authority | AR Contractors Licensing Board (ACLB)
 Verification | <https://www.aclb.arkansas.gov/> - "Find A Licensed Contractor"
 Required | Commercial contractors >= \$50,000; residential builders > \$2,000 (Residential Builders Committee).
 Notes | Confirm commercial vs. residential path.

California (CA)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | A - Statewide
 Primary authority | Contractors State License Board (CSLB)
 Verification | <https://www.cslb.ca.gov/OnlineServices/CheckLicenseII/CheckLicense.aspx>
 Required | CSLB license for virtually all construction >= \$500 (including specialty C-classes). ~45 classifications (A, B, C-series). HIS registration for home-improvement salespeople.
 Notes | Strong consumer-protection state. Unlicensed contractors cannot sue for payment (B&P § 7031). Check bond, workers' comp, and complaint disclosure on CSLB record.

Colorado (CO)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | C - Local GC; B - state trades
 Primary authority | CO Dept. of Regulatory Agencies (DORA) - trades only
 Verification | <https://dpo.colorado.gov/Lookup>
 Required | No statewide GC license. State licenses electricians and plumbers. GC, roofing, HVAC typically city/county licensed.
 Notes | Always check local building department where work occurs (Denver, Colorado Springs, etc.).

Connecticut (CT)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | B - Registration (HIC)
 Primary authority | CT Dept. of Consumer Protection (DCP)
 Verification | <https://www.elicense.ct.gov/Lookup/LicenseLookup.aspx>
 Required | Home Improvement Contractor (HIC) and New Home Construction Contractor registration for residential work > \$200.
 Notes | Registration is consumer-protection oriented, not a competency exam. Trades may have separate requirements.

Delaware (DE)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | C - Local + business registration
 Primary authority | DE Division of Revenue (business license); DE Dept. of Labor (contractor registration)
 Verification | <https://onestop.delaware.gov/> - business license search
 Required | No statewide competency GC license. Business license + labor registration; local contractor licensing (e.g., New Castle County permit-endorsed license).
 Secondary lookup | New Castle County: <https://www3.newcastledelaware.gov/contractorlicense/search/>
 Notes | Three counties have different rules.

District of Columbia (DC)

|

|---|---|
 Regime | A - Registration with endorsements
 Primary authority | DC Dept. of Licensing and Consumer Protection (DLCP)
 Verification | <https://dlcp.dc.gov/page/verify-business-license>
 Required | Basic Business License (BBL) with construction endorsement - General Contractor Class A/B, Home Improvement Contractor, or specialty.
 Notes | Not a state; treated as its own jurisdiction for licensing.

Florida (FL)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | A - Statewide
 Primary authority | FL Dept. of Business & Professional Regulation (DBPR)
 Verification | <https://www.myfloridalicense.com/wl11.asp>
 Required | State-certified or registered contractor licenses by division (General, Building, Residential, specialty trades). Many trades separately licensed.
 Notes | County/municipal registration may also apply. DBPR shows status, expiration, and disciplinary actions.

Georgia (GA)

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 |---|---|
 Regime | A - Statewide
 Primary authority | GA Secretary of State - Residential & General Contractors Board
 Verification | <https://verify.sos.ga.gov/verification/>
 Required | Residential and general contractor licenses for work > \$2,500. Electrical, plumbing, HVAC, low-voltage via separate boards.
 Notes | Confirm license type matches residential vs. general/commercial scope.

Hawaii (HI)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | A - Statewide
 Primary authority | HI Dept. of Commerce & Consumer Affairs (DCCA) - PVL
 Verification | <https://mypvl.dcca.hawaii.gov/public-license-search/>
 Required | Contractor license (CT classification) plus trade specialty licenses as applicable.
 Notes | Check island/county permit requirements separately.

Idaho (ID)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | B - Registration
 Primary authority | ID Division of Occupational & Professional Licenses (DOPL) - Contractors Board
 Verification | <https://dopl.idaho.gov/> - contractor registration search
 Required | Contractor registration for construction > \$2,000; electrical, plumbing, HVAC separately licensed.
 Notes | Registration ? competency exam.

Illinois (IL)

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|---|---|
 Regime | C - Local GC/trades; B - limited state trades
 Primary authority | IL Dept. of Financial & Professional Regulation (IDFPR) - roofing; IL Dept. of Public Health - plumbing
 Verification | <https://online-dfpr.micropact.com/Lookup/LicenseLookup.aspx>
 Required | No statewide GC license. State roofing contractor license (IDFPR); plumbing (IDPH/IDFPR). Electrical, HVAC, and GC licensed by municipality.
 Notes | Chicago has its own extensive system - do not assume state credentials cover Chicago work. See [municipal table](#municipal-licensing-il-in-ny-mo-pa).

Indiana (IN)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | C - Local GC/trades; B - state plumbing only
 Primary authority | IN Professional Licensing Agency (PLA) - Plumbing Commission
 Verification | <https://mylicense.in.gov/EVerification/Search.aspx>
 Required | Plumbers licensed statewide. GC, electrical, HVAC licensed locally (city/county).
 Notes | Indianapolis uses Accela (<https://accela9ca.indy.gov/>). No single statewide GC/trade rollup. See [municipal table](#municipal-licensing-il-in-ny-mo-pa).

Iowa (IA)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | B - Registration
 Primary authority | IA Dept. of Inspections, Appeals & Licensing (DIAL)
 Verification | <https://iowadial.gov/> - public contractor search
 Required | Contractor registration for construction businesses earning >= \$2,000/yr (workers' comp / UI compliance). Trades separately licensed.
 Notes | Registration tied to compliance, not competency testing.

Kansas (KS)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | C - Local only
 Primary authority | City/county building departments
 Verification | No statewide portal - contact local building department
 Required | No statewide contractor license. All trades and GC rules are local (varies widely).
 Secondary | KS roofer registration (limited state role): check AG/building dept.
 Notes | Kansas Business Center lists local contacts: <https://www.kansas.gov/businesscenter/>

Kentucky (KY)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | B - Trades only
 Primary authority | KY Dept. of Housing, Buildings & Construction (HBC)
 Verification | <https://hbc.ky.gov/Pages/License-Search.aspx>
 Required | State licenses for electrical, plumbing, HVAC, boiler/fire protection. No statewide GC license - local rules apply.
 Notes | Verify GC with local building department.

Louisiana (LA)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide
Primary authority | LA State Licensing Board for Contractors (LSLBC)
Verification | <https://www.lslbc.louisiana.gov/contractor-search/>
Required | Commercial >= \$50,000; residential >= \$75,000 (amounts subject to change - confirm with LSLBC). Mold remediation and other specialties separately classified.
Notes | Check license type, monetary limit, and classification.

Maine (ME)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Trades; residential contractor law pending
Primary authority | ME Office of Professional & Occupational Regulation (OPOR)
Verification | <https://www.pfr.maine.gov/ALMSOnline/ALMSQuery/Welcome.aspx>
Required | Electricians and plumbers licensed statewide. Residential contractor license effective Jan 1, 2027 (per 2024 legislation). No statewide GC license currently.
Notes | Check town-level rules until residential license fully effective.

Maryland (MD)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - HIC + trades
Primary authority | MD Home Improvement Commission (MHIC), Dept. of Labor
Verification | https://www.dllr.state.md.us/license/mhic/mhic_search.shtml
Required | MHIC license for home improvement work. Electrical, plumbing, HVACR via separate MD boards.
Notes | MHIC record shows complaints. Commercial GC may involve different pathways - confirm scope.

Massachusetts (MA)

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|---|---|
Regime | B - CSL + HIC
Primary authority | MA Board of Building Regulations & Standards (BBRS) / MA Contractor Hub
Verification | <https://www.mass.gov/info-details/massachusetts-construction-supervisor-license-csl>
Required | Construction Supervisor License (CSL) for structural work; Home Improvement Contractor (HIC) registration for residential remodeling.
Notes | CSL and HIC are separate - verify both when applicable.

Michigan (MI)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Residential + trades
Primary authority | MI Dept. of Licensing & Regulatory Affairs (LARA)
Verification | <https://www.lara.michigan.gov/colaLicVerify/>
Required | Residential builder and maintenance & alteration contractor licenses. Electrical, plumbing, mechanical separately licensed.
Notes | Confirm residential vs. commercial scope on license.

Minnesota (MN)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Residential + trades
Primary authority | MN Dept. of Labor & Industry (DLI)
Verification | <https://www.dli.mn.gov/business/contractors/license-and-registration-lookup>
Required | Residential building contractor, remodeler, roofer licenses. Electrical, plumbing, high-pressure piping separately licensed.
Notes | DLI shows bond information.

Mississippi (MS)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide
Primary authority | MS State Board of Contractors (MSBOC)
Verification | <https://www.msboconline.com/verification.php>
Required | Commercial (Certificate of Responsibility) and residential builder/remodeler/roofer licenses statewide.
Notes | Check project amount thresholds and classification.

Missouri (MO)

|
|---|---|
Regime | C - Local GC/trades
Primary authority | City/county building departments; MO Division of Professional Registration (electrical only)
Verification | State electrical: <https://pr.mo.gov/licensee-search.asp> - GC/trades: local portals
Required | No statewide GC license. Optional statewide electrical contractor license. St. Louis, Kansas City, Springfield, and St. Louis County have notable local trade + GC licensing.
Notes | SOS confirms business entity only, not trade competency. See [municipal table](#municipal-licensing-il-in-ny-mo-pa).

Montana (MT)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Registration
Primary authority | MT Dept. of Labor & Industry
Verification | <https://erd.dli.mt.gov/work-comp-reg/contractors/>
Required | Construction Contractor Registration (workers' comp based) for businesses with employees; Independent Contractor Exemption Certificate (ICEC) for qualifying sole proprietors.
Notes | Registration ? competency license. Trades may require separate credentials.

Nebraska (NE)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Registration
Primary authority | NE Dept. of Labor
Verification | <https://www.nebraska.gov/dol/contractor/search>
Required | Contractor registration for work on others' property (exempt if < \$5,000/yr). Electricians separately licensed.
Notes | Registration is administrative, not exam-based.

Nevada (NV)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide
Primary authority | NV State Contractors Board (NSCB)
Verification | <https://app.nvcontractorsboard.com/Clients/NVSCB/Public/ContractorLicenseSearch/ContractorLicenseSearch.aspx>
Required | NSCB license for all construction trades; monetary limit on license.
Notes | Check classification, license limit, and disciplinary history.

New Hampshire (NH)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Trades only
Primary authority | NH Office of Professional Licensure & Certification (OPLC)
Verification | <https://www.oplc.nh.gov/>
Required | Electricians, plumbers, gas/mechanical trades licensed statewide. No statewide GC license - local rules.
Notes | Verify GC with town/city building department.

New Jersey (NJ)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - HIC registration
Primary authority | NJ Division of Consumer Affairs (DCA)
Verification | <https://newjersey.mylicense.com/verification/>
Required | Home Improvement Contractor (HIC) registration (NJHIC#) required annually for home improvement work.
Notes | Registration ? competency exam. Electrical, plumbing, HVAC have separate boards.

New Mexico (NM)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide
Primary authority | NM Regulation & Licensing Dept. - Construction Industries Division (CID)
Verification | <https://public.rld.state.nm.us/PublicWebSearch/>
Required | GB (general building), mechanical, plumbing, electrical, and specialty contractor licenses (exam + bond; no dollar threshold).
Notes | Confirm qualifying party on record. Strong statewide licensing.

New York (NY)

|
|---|---|
Regime | C - Local GC/trades (all construction locally regulated)
Primary authority | City/county licensing (no statewide GC board)
Verification | NYC HIC: <https://a866-dcwbp.nyc.gov/search> - NYC trades: <https://www.nyc.gov/site/buildings/property-or-business-owner/find-licensed-professionals.page>
Required | No statewide GC or trade license. NYC DCWP HIC (work > \$200); NYC DOB skilled trades; Nassau, Suffolk, Westchester, Rochester, Yonkers each have separate rules.
Notes | Always verify with the municipality where work occurs. See [municipal table](#municipal-licensing-il-in-ny-mo-pa).

North Carolina (NC)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide
Primary authority | NC Licensing Board for General Contractors (NCLBGC)
Verification | <https://nclicensing.org/>
Required | GC license for projects >= \$40,000 (confirm current threshold with NCLBGC). Plumbing, HVAC, electrical via separate boards.
Notes | Reciprocity with some neighboring states for certain classifications.

North Dakota (ND)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide
Primary authority | ND Secretary of State - Contractor Licensing
Verification | <https://firststop.sos.nd.gov/search/contractors>
Required | Contractor license for work > \$4,000; Classes A-D by contract value.
Notes | Verify good standing, class, and expiration.

Ohio (OH)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Trades only
Primary authority | OH Construction Industry Licensing Board (OCILB)
Verification | https://elicense.ohio.gov/oh_verifylicense
Required | State licenses for commercial plumbing, HVAC, electrical, hydronics, refrigeration. No statewide GC license - local (city/county).
Notes | OCILB covers commercial trades only; residential trade rules may differ locally.

Oklahoma (OK)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Trades only
Primary authority | OK Construction Industries Board (CIB)
Verification | https://www.ok.gov/cib/Are_They_Licensed/
Required | CIB licenses electrical, plumbing, mechanical (HVAC), roofing, and inspectors. No statewide GC license.
Notes | Verify GC with local building department.

Oregon (OR)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - CCB registration plus BCD trade licenses
Primary authority | OR Construction Contractors Board (CCB) and OR Building Codes Division (BCD)
Verification | CCB: <https://search.ccb.state.or.us/search/> - BCD trades: <https://www.oregon.gov/bcd/licensing/pages/search.aspx>
Required | CCB registration for all paid construction. Separate BCD trade license for electrical, plumbing, boiler, elevator, manufactured dwelling, and mechanical/HVAC.
Both required when trade work is performed.
Notes | Verify both portals independently - active CCB does not authorize trade work. CCB record shows bond, insurance, complaint history. See [Oregon dual-license

section](#oregon--ccb-registration-and-bcd-trade-licenses).

Pennsylvania (PA)

|
|---|---|
Regime | C - HIC registration + local GC/trades
Primary authority | PA Office of Attorney General (HIC); local municipalities (trades/GC)
Verification | HIC Reg: https://www.attorneygeneral.gov/Consumer_Home_ContractorSearch/ - Philadelphia: <https://li.phila.gov/contractor-lookup>
Required | HIC registration for > \$5,000/yr residential work. No statewide GC or trade competency license - ~2,500 municipalities may require local elec/plumb/GC licenses.
Notes | PA DLI confirms asbestos, lead, crane only. Philadelphia and Pittsburgh have robust local trade licensing. See [municipal table](#municipal-licensing-il-in-ny-mo-pa).

Rhode Island (RI)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Registration + specialty licenses
Primary authority | RI Contractors' Registration & Licensing Board (CRLB)
Verification | <https://crb.ri.gov/PublicPortal/>
Required | All general contractors must register with CRLB; specialty trades (roofers, well drillers, etc.) separately licensed.
Notes | Distinguish registration vs. specialty license on record.

South Carolina (SC)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide
Primary authority | SC Dept. of Labor, Licensing & Regulation (LLR)
Verification | <https://verify.llronline.com/LicLookup/Contractor/Contractor.aspx>
Required | General and mechanical contractor licenses via LLR Contractors' Licensing Board. Residential builders via Residential Builders Commission (separate LLR search).
Notes | Use correct LLR search for GC vs. residential builder.

South Dakota (SD)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Trades only
Primary authority | SD Dept. of Labor & Regulation - Electrical/Plumbing/Mechanical commissions
Verification | <https://dlr.sd.gov/> - occupational licensing boards
Required | State licenses for electricians, plumbers, HVAC. No statewide GC license.
Notes | Verify GC with local building department.

Tennessee (TN)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Statewide
Primary authority | TN Board for Licensing Contractors (BLC)
Verification | <https://verify.tn.gov/>

Required | General/commercial contractor and home improvement contractor licenses, each with a monetary limit (max project size). Limited Licensed Electrician (LLE) and Limited Licensed Plumber (LLP) for smaller jurisdictions.

Notes | Confirm monetary limit covers project value. Check classification.

Texas (TX)

|

|---|---|

Regime | B - Trades only

Primary authority | TX Dept. of Licensing & Regulation (TDLR)

Verification | <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/LicenseSearch/>

Required | No statewide GC license. TDLR licenses HVAC, electrical, plumbing, and other regulated trades statewide. GC verified at city/county level.

Notes | Major cities (Houston, Dallas, Austin, San Antonio) have local GC registration. Always check local AHJ.

Utah (UT)

|

|---|---|

Regime | A - Statewide

Primary authority | UT Division of Professional Licensing (DOPL)

Verification | <https://secure.utah.gov/llv/search/index.html>

Required | General and specialty contractor licenses; electricians and plumbers separately licensed. Construction Business Registry also applies.

Notes | Confirm qualifier and classification on DOPL record.

Vermont (VT)

|

|---|---|

Regime | B - Registration

Primary authority | VT Office of Professional Regulation (OPR), Secretary of State

Verification | <https://sos.vermont.gov/construction-contractor-registration/>

Required | Residential contractor registration for projects >= \$10,000 (insurance + contract attestations). Trades separately regulated.

Notes | Registration ? competency exam.

Virginia (VA)

|

|---|---|

Regime | A - Statewide

Primary authority | VA Dept. of Professional & Occupational Regulation (DPOR)

Verification | <https://www.dpor.virginia.gov/LicenseLookup>

Required | Contractor licenses Class A/B/C by project value; tradesmen licenses for specific trades.

Notes | Check class (A = unlimited, B/C = limited by value) and specialty.

Washington (WA)

|

|---|---|

Regime | A - Statewide registration

Primary authority | WA Dept. of Labor & Industries (L&I)

Verification | <https://secure.lni.wa.gov/verify/>
 Required | Contractor registration required for all construction; specialty trades separately licensed.
 Notes | L&I record shows bond, insurance, workers' comp, and lawsuits against bond.

West Virginia (WV)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | A - Statewide
 Primary authority | WV Contractor Licensing Board (Division of Labor)
 Verification | <https://labor.wv.gov/Pages/Contractor-Licensing.aspx> - database search
 Required | Statewide contractor license for most construction; HVAC, plumber licenses via same division.
 Notes | Confirm classification and local permit requirements.

Wisconsin (WI)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | B - Dwelling contractor + trades
 Primary authority | WI Dept. of Safety & Professional Services (DSPS)
 Verification | <https://licensespace.wi.gov/>
 Required | Dwelling Contractor certification + Dwelling Contractor Qualifier for 1-2 family homes. Electrical, plumbing, HVAC separately licensed.
 Notes | Commercial GC rules differ - confirm credential matches project type.

Wyoming (WY)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | C - Local GC; B - electrical only
 Primary authority | WY State Fire Marshal - Electrical Licensing
 Verification | <https://wsfm.wyo.gov/electrical-licensing> - electrical only
 Required | No statewide GC, plumbing, or HVAC license. Only electricians licensed statewide. GC/plumbing/HVAC are local.
 Notes | Verify with city/county building department where work occurs.

U.S. territories

Guam (GU)

|
 |---|---|
 Regime | A - Statewide (territorial)
 Primary authority | Guam Contractors Licensing Board (CLB)
 Verification | <https://clb.guam.gov/> - published contractor list; phone verification: (671) 649-2211
 Required | Territorial contractor license required to perform construction on Guam. Classifications include general building (A & B) and specialty trades.
 Notes | Public Law 33-103 requires publication of licensed contractor list. Suspended/revoked list posted on CLB site. No online name search as robust as mainland boards - call CLB to verify if not found on published roster.

Puerto Rico (PR)

|
|---|---|
Regime | B - Registration + trade licenses
Primary authority | PR Dept. of Consumer Affairs (DACO) - Registro de Contratistas
Verification | Contractor registry: <https://www.daco.pr.gov/consumidores/listado-contratistas-registrados/>
Required | Contractor registration (Law 146-1995) for residential construction, home improvements, essential repairs, and roof treatments. Professional trades (electricians, plumbers, engineers) licensed separately via PR Dept. of State examining boards.
Secondary lookup | Trade/professional licenses: <https://pr.pcshq.com/lookup/en/>
Notes | Registration is distinct from professional trade licensure. Check DACO complaint registry. Commercial construction may involve additional requirements - confirm with DACO.

U.S. Virgin Islands (VI)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Territorial licensing
Primary authority | VI Dept. of Licensing & Consumer Affairs (DLCA)
Verification | https://secure.dlca.vi.gov/license/Asps/Search/License_search.aspx
Required | Business/trade licenses issued by DLCA for construction-related activities. Search by business name, license number, island (St. Thomas, St. Croix, St. John).
Notes | Island-specific licensing may apply. Confirm license type matches business activity.

Northern Mariana Islands (CNMI)

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|---|---|
Regime | A - Professional licensing
Primary authority | CNMI Board of Professional Licensing (BPL)
Verification | <https://www.cnmilicensing.gov.mp/> - online apply/renew via Localgov platform
Required | Professional licenses for regulated construction-related disciplines (14 disciplines under BPL).
Notes | Online portal handles applications and renewals. Contact BPL for verification if public search is limited: P.O. Box 502078, Saipan, MP 96950.

American Samoa (AS)

|
|---|---|
Regime | A - Territorial (business license)
Primary authority | American Samoa Dept. of Commerce (DOC), Business License Division
Verification | No public online lookup identified. Contact DOC directly or verify in person.
Required | Contractor license issued as subcategory of business license under ASCA Title 27. Classifications: general building, electrical (also requires ASPA registration), plumbing, mechanical/HVAC, specialty. Unlicensed work > \$1,000 subject to penalties.
Secondary | Building permits: ASG Dept. of Public Works - https://asgpublicworks.as/building_branch
Notes | Land use and building permits required before work begins (Dept. of Commerce + DPW). Federal compact projects may require additional compliance verification.

Municipal licensing - IL, IN, NY, MO, PA

These five states decentralize general contracting and most trade licensing to

cities and counties. State-level lookups alone are insufficient for vetting.

Use the table below after checking any applicable state credential (HIC Reg, state plumbing, state roofing, etc.).

> Also see: Municipal follow-up - registration ? licensure for AK, CT, IA, ID, MA, MT, NE, NJ, RI, VT, WA, PR where state registration is not a competency license.

Illinois (IL)

Municipality / scope | Verification URL | Licenses covered

| --- | --- | --- |

State - roofing | <https://online-dfpr.micropact.com/Lookup/LicenseLookup.aspx> | Roofing (1-6 unit residential)

State - plumbing | Same IDFPR portal | Plumbers statewide

Chicago | <https://webapps1.chicago.gov/licensedcontractors/> | GC, electrical, plumbing, masonry, elevator

DuPage Co. (unincorporated) | <https://aca-prod.accela.com/DUPAGE/GeneralProperty/PropertyLookUp.aspx?TabName=Home&isLicensee=Y> | GC + sub-contractor registration

Naperville | <https://www.naperville.il.us/> - (630) 420-6100 | Local contractor registration

Aurora | <https://etrakit.aurora-il.org/> | Local permits/licenses

Collar counties / downstate | Local building department | No statewide rollup - HVAC, electrical, GC all local outside Chicago

Vetting note: IDFPR and Chicago DOB portals do not sync. A "state-licensed"

roofing credential does not cover Chicago GC or electrical work.

Indiana (IN)

Municipality / scope | Verification URL | Licenses covered

| --- | --- | --- |

State - plumbing only | <https://mylicense.in.gov/EVerification/Search.aspx> | Plumbers statewide

Indianapolis / Marion Co. | <https://accela9ca.indy.gov/> | Electrical, plumbing, HVAC permits & contractors

Fort Wayne | Local building department | GC + trades local

Other IN cities | Local building department | Electrical, HVAC, GC - all local

New York (NY)

Municipality / scope | Verification URL | Licenses covered

| --- | --- | --- |

NYC - HIC | <https://a866-dcwbp.nyc.gov/search> | Home improvement > \$200

NYC - skilled trades | <https://www.nyc.gov/site/buildings/property-or-business-owner/find-licensed-professionals.page> | DOB trades + registrants

Nassau County | (516) 571-2600 | County consumer affairs

Suffolk County | (631) 853-4600 | County consumer affairs

Westchester County | (914) 995-2155 | County consumer protection

Rochester | <http://Infor.CityofRochester.gov> - (585) 428-9339 | Electrical, plumbing, SE/RO

Yonkers | (914) 377-6808 | Home improvement contractors

Other NY cities/towns | Local building department | All construction locally regulated

Vetting note: Except asbestos abatement, all construction is local in NY.

NYC DCWP HIC is not valid outside NYC.

Missouri (MO)

Municipality / scope | Verification URL | Licenses covered

| --- | --- | --- |

State - electrical (optional) | <https://pr.mo.gov/licensee-search.asp> | Statewide electrical contractor
 Kansas City - contractor/trade | <https://compasskc.kcmo.org/> | Certificate of Qualification + contractor license by trade
 Kansas City - business license | <https://www.kcmo.gov/city-hall/departments/finance/business-license-search> | Business license (? trade license)
 St. Louis City - business | <https://www.stlouis-mo.gov/government/departments/license/business-license-search.cfm> | Graduated Business License (GBL)
 St. Louis City - trades | Building Division - (314) 622-3313 | Mechanical, electrical, plumbing certification
 St. Louis County | Dept. of Transportation & Public Works - (314) 615-5184 | Mechanical/trades (unincorporated + participating cities)
 Springfield / other MO | Local building department | GC, plumbing, HVAC - all local

Vetting note: MOPRO shows state electrical licenses only. GC and most trades require a city/county search.

Pennsylvania (PA)

Municipality / scope | Verification URL | Licenses covered

| --- | --- | --- |

State - HIC Reg | https://www.attorneygeneral.gov/Consumer_Home_ContractorSearch/ | Residential HIC Reg > \$5k/yr

State - asbestos/lead/crane | <https://www.pa.gov/agencies/dli/> | Special certifications only

Philadelphia - contractor | <https://li.phila.gov/contractor-lookup> | GC + trade violations

Philadelphia - trade search | <https://eclipse.phila.gov/phillylmsprod/pub/lms/Default.aspx?PossePresentation=PublicTradeLicenseSearch> | Elec, plumb, fire, demolition, warm air, etc.

Pittsburgh - PLI | <https://onestoppgh.pittsburghpa.gov/pghprod/webui/> | GC + trade licenses

Other PA municipalities | Contact borough/township | PA DLI maintains no master list - 2,500+ municipalities set own rules

Vetting note: PA HIC Reg is consumer-protection registration, not a trade competency license. Philadelphia requires local trade licenses even when PA HIC Reg is active.

Municipal follow-up - registration ? licensure

These states issue registration (or consumer-protection registration) at the state level. Registration confirms administrative compliance - it is not equivalent to a competency license and typically does not authorize trade work on its own. Most also license trades separately at the state level; many cities and counties add local contractor, trade, or business licenses.

Compact table: [contractor-licensing-quick-lookup-table.md](#) - "Municipal follow-up" section.

State | State registration / Reg portal | Also verify (trades) | Key municipal portals

| --- | --- | --- | --- |

AK | <https://www.commerce.alaska.gov/cbp/main/Search/Professional> | State Reg classification | Anchorage: <https://bsd.muni.org/contractorlicensing/search.aspx>

CT | <https://www.elicense.ct.gov/Lookup/LicenseLookup.aspx> | HIC/NHCC Reg + state trade licenses | Town ROW licenses (local engineering dept)

IA | <https://dial.iowa.gov/licenses/building/contractors> | PMSB plumbing/mechanical license | Des Moines / Cedar Rapids building dept

ID | <https://dopl.idaho.gov/> | DOPL electrical/plumbing/HVAC licenses | Boise: <https://permits.cityofboise.org/citizenaccess/>

MA | HIC Reg + CSL license | eLIPSE/OPSI trade licenses | Every city/town business certificate

MT | <https://erdcontractors.mt.gov/ICCROnlineSearch/registrationlookup.jsp> | POL: <https://aca-prod.accela.com/POL/> | Billings, Missoula, Bozeman

NE | <https://www.nebraska.gov/dol/contractor/search> | State electrician license | Omaha - Lincoln Accela portals

NJ | <https://newjersey.mylicense.com/verification/> | NJHIC Reg + state trade licenses | Newark - Jersey City (jcnj.org/permitportal)

RI | <https://crb.ecms.ri.gov/consumer/search-registrantlicensee> | CRLB registration + specialty licenses | Local building official

VT | <https://sos.vermont.gov/construction-contractor-registration/> | DPS trade licenses | Local building department
 WA | <https://secure.lni.wa.gov/verify/> | L&I trade certification (same portal) | Olympia - Seattle SDCI
 PR | <https://www.daco.pr.gov/consumidores/listado-contratistas-registrados/> | <https://pr.pcshq.com/lookup/en/> | Local municipio

Credential layers to verify in registration states:

1. State registration (HIC, NJHIC, DACO, DIAL, DOL, CRLB, etc.)
2. State trade license on the correct board (often a different search)
3. Municipal contractor/trade/business license for the job site
4. Permit eligibility in that jurisdiction

See the quick lookup table for municipality-specific URLs (Omaha, Lincoln, Anchorage, Boise, Newark, Jersey City, Austin, Dallas, San Antonio, etc.).

Local jurisdiction checklist

Use when the state row shows Regime C, Trade-only, "local check", registration (Reg), or for IL, IN, NY, MO, PA regardless of trade:

1. Identify the city and county of the job site.
2. Run the state registration lookup (if applicable) - confirm it is not mistaken for a trade license.
3. Run the state trade license lookup on the correct board (may be a different portal).
4. Search "[city/county] contractor license lookup" or use municipal URLs in the quick lookup table.
5. Confirm whether a local GC license, trade license, supervisor certificate, or business tax receipt is required.
6. Notable local licensing cities: Chicago (IL), NYC (NY), Philadelphia (PA), Pittsburgh (PA), Indianapolis (IN), Omaha/Lincoln (NE), Anchorage (AK), Kansas City / St. Louis (MO), Austin/Dallas/San Antonio (TX), Denver (CO).
7. For Oregon, verify both CCB and BCD regardless of municipality.

Reciprocity and multi-state work

- **No universal reciprocity.** A license in one state rarely authorizes work in another.
- **Partial reciprocity** exists between some neighboring states for specific classifications (e.g., NC ? TN ? GA in limited cases).
- SPs working across state lines typically need **separate licenses** in each state where work is performed.
- Always verify the receiving state's requirements directly with the licensing board.

Red flags during verification

Signal | Action

| --- | --- |

No license number when one is required | Stop - request number; verify before proceeding

Status expired, suspended, or revoked | Hard stop - do not engage

Business name mismatch (license vs. contract) | Investigate entity structure; may be subcontractor issue

Classification doesn't cover scope | Require correct license or licensed subcontractor
 Refusal to provide license number | Treat as disqualifying for licensed work
 Only business registration (SOS) found, no contractor license | SOS ? contractor authorization - keep searching
 Out-of-state license offered for in-state work | Invalid unless reciprocity confirmed in writing with board

External reference sources

Source | URL | Notes

| --- | --- | --- |

NASCLA | <https://www.nascla.org/> | National Association of State Contractors Licensing Agencies; publishes annual CSLID covering 50 states + Guam + USVI
 NASCLA CSLID (print/digital) | <https://store.nascla.org/> | Paid comprehensive directory - authoritative for exam, bond, fee, reciprocity details
 ICC / adopted codes | <https://www.iccsafe.org/> | States adopt different code editions (IBC, IRC, NEC) - affects permit requirements

Vetting workflow integration

When running a Service Provider Vetting Report, use this guide at Step 1 (licenses) and Manual Review Checklist items:

- [] Verify all licenses directly with licensing boards.
- [] Confirm license status, expiration date, and disciplinary history.

Cross-reference with:

- Secretary of State / business registry (entity status ? contractor license)
- Local building department (Regime B/C states)
- Trade-specific boards when SP self-performs electrical, plumbing, or HVAC
 - ****Specialty boards**** when scope includes backflow testing, fire sprinkler/alarm, pest control, or locksmith/low-voltage/access control - see contractor-licensing-specialty-trades.md

Document "Not Found" with the specific board searched and date attempted.